

Position Paper Template

Unit 2 summative assessment · Four-section structured document

Committee: _____

Topic: _____

Country: _____

Delegate: _____

SECTION 01 — BACKGROUND

Define the global issue — factually, not from your country's perspective.

- What is the issue? Define it clearly and specifically.
- Who is affected? Name key stakeholders — countries, populations, groups.
- What is the scale? Use statistics and concrete examples.
- Why now? Establish current urgency. What has recently changed?
- Write factually — no country position yet.

DRAFT SPACE

Common mistake The most common error: expressing your country's view here. The Background describes the world as it is.

SECTION 02 — PAST INTERNATIONAL ACTIONS

What has already been tried, and what have the results been?

- Find key UN resolutions — cite by number, date, and provision.
- Include treaties, regional agreements, NGO initiatives.
- Evaluate, don't just list — what worked? What fell short?
- Show the gap: why is this still before the committee?

DRAFT SPACE

Common mistake Listing resolutions without evaluation scores poorly. 'The UN passed X in 2010' tells us nothing.

SECTION 03 — COUNTRY POLICY

Your assigned country's official position, interests, and past actions.

- State your country's actual policy — not what you think it should be.

- Cite evidence: voting records, official speeches, treaty ratifications.
- Explain why your country holds this position — history, economy, geography.
- Acknowledge complexity — nuanced papers score higher.

DRAFT SPACE

Common mistake Writing what you think your country should do rather than what it actually does.

SECTION 04 — POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS

Actionable recommendations consistent with your country's policy.

- Solutions must be consistent with your Country Policy (Section 3).
- Solutions must be within your committee's powers.
- Be specific: mechanisms, timelines, named actors.
- Anticipate objections and show common ground.
- Draft solutions as if they will become operative clauses.

DRAFT SPACE

Common mistake Proposing solutions your own country would veto, or that exceed the committee's authority.